IoT Embedded Alert System

Proof of Concept — Report

ESP32 + Hall Sensor + Telegram Alert

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1 Project Identification

1.1 Solution Name

IoT Seismograph — Real-time seismic detection system using a Hall-effect sensor and an oscillating magnet mounted on a mechanical pendulum, with instant alerting via Telegram Bot API.

1.2 Proposed Applications

1. **Intelligent Seismic Detector (ISD)** — critical vibration monitoring
2. Door Opening Detector — building security / access audit
3. Vehicle Counter for Parking — smart access automation

2 Context and Problem Statement

2.1 Use Context

Target deployment: environments where undetected vibrations can cause hardware damage before any human intervention. Primary scenario: a data center where undetected micro-vibrations cause intermittent hard drive failures. Administrators only discover the issue after data loss. An early warning system enables intervention before hardware failure.

Secondary scenarios:

- Hospital or laboratory (sensitive equipment protection)
- Underground parking (heavy vehicle vibration detection)
- Electrical substation

2.2 General Objective

Demonstrate the feasibility of an autonomous, real-time, low-cost IoT system capable of detecting seismic events (P-waves ideally) with instant notification via a secure channel (Telegram Bot API).

3 Solution Value

3.1 Key Benefits

- **Automatic detection**: zero manual intervention, 24/7 operation

- **Real-time alert**: notification within 5 s via Telegram (WiFi)
- **Low cost**: commodity hardware (ESP32 + KY-003 Hall sensor)
- **Noise discrimination**: threshold-based filter separates genuine seismic patterns from electrical rebounds and industrial machines
- **Resilience**: local serial output continues if WiFi is unavailable

3.2 Alert Use Cases

1. *Major seismic alert* → urgent Telegram message, immediate response required
2. *Moderate pre-alert* → informational notification, manual investigation
3. *Vibration anomaly* → distinguishes isolated shock (noise) from sustained seismic event (duration > 3 s)

4 Hardware and Software Resources

4.1 Hardware Components

Component	Role
ESP32	Main MCU, WiFi, GPIO
KY-003 Hall Magnetic Field Sensor	Oscillation detector
Oscillating magnet (pendulum)	Mechanical seismic transducer
128×64 OLED screen	Local status display
Spring / suspension wire	Mechanical pendulum assembly
External battery / USB power	Power supply
Enclosure / support	Physical mounting

Table 1: Hardware bill of materials

4.2 Software Environment

- **Language**: Lua 5.3.4 on LuaRTOS
- **Modules**: `pio`, `net.wf`, `net.curl`, `tmr`, `thread`, `os`, `string`
- **External API**: Telegram Bot API — `https://api.telegram.org/bot[TOKEN]/sendMessage`

5 Technical Details of the PoC

5.1 System Architecture

The system operates in two layers:

1. **Sensor layer** (30–50 ms polling): reads the Hall pin, counts falling edges (magnet passes), evaluates the count every 3–7 seconds against thresholds.
2. **Communication layer** (async thread): picks up alert level from shared variable, constructs and sends HTTPS GET request to Telegram API, enforces 30-second anti-spam cooldown.

5.2 Detection Algorithm

```lua
-- Analysis every 3 seconds
if os.time() - start_time >= 3 then
    if detections >= 5 and not send_in_progress then
        local level = "LOW"
        if detections >= 10 then level = "MODERATE" end
        if detections >= 20 then level = "HIGH"     end

        -- Pass alert to Telegram thread
        alert_level        = level
        alert_oscillations = detections
    end
    detections = 0
    start_time = os.time()
end
```

Listing 1: Sensor thread core logic

5.3 Alert Thresholds

Parameter	Value	Justification
Min threshold S_{min}	5 oscillations / 3 s	Below = electrical rebound noise
Max threshold S_{max}	40 oscillations / s	Above = industrial fans (50–60 Hz)
Confirmation duration	3 s	Isolates single shock vs sustained seism
Analysis cycle	7 s (debug) / 3 s (prod)	Balances latency and CPU load
Anti-spam cooldown	30 s minimum	Prevents 10+ messages for one event

Table 2: Detection parameter justification

5.4 Noise vs Real Event Discrimination

- **Object falling on table** (noise): peak of 50 fronts/s for 0.2 s → filtered ($> S_{max}$), then immediate silence
- **Seismic event** (real): 8–15 fronts/s for 5–10 s continuously → confirmed, chaotic pattern
- **Industrial motor at 50 Hz** (noise): constant 50 fronts/s for hours → filtered ($> S_{max}$)

5.5 Security Analysis

The Telegram alert travels in plaintext over WiFi. Identified risks and mitigations:

Threat	Risk	Mitigation
Replay attack	Attacker resends captured message	Sequence number counter (16-bit)
Message forgery	Fake alert injected	HMAC-SHA256 signature (requires porting crypto lib)
Token exposure	Firmware extraction → bot abuse	Store in encrypted EEPROM; revoke after demo
WPA2 interception	Token visible in cleartext	Enforce WPA3; add VPN (heavy for ESP32)

Table 3: Security threat matrix

Sequence number anti-replay (Lua pseudocode):

```lua
local sequence = 0
function send_alert(level, count)
    sequence = (sequence + 1) % 65536
    local msg = level .. "|" .. count .. "|" .. sequence
    -- Server-side: reject if sequence <= last_seen_sequence
end
```

Listing 2: Anti-replay sequence counter

6 Limitations

6.1 Physical Limitations

- **Single-axis**: Hall sensor detects only vertical movement. Lateral tremors (East-West, North-South) are missed — 66% sensitivity reduction for horizontal seismic waves. Mitigation: add 2 additional Hall sensors on perpendicular axes.
- **No amplitude measurement**: binary detection (0/1). Richter scale approximated to 3 levels only.

6.2 Network Limitations

- **WiFi dependency**: no Telegram notification if WiFi goes down.
- **Telegram latency**: HTTP REST adds 2–5 s. Acceptable since seismic events last 10–30 s.

6.3 Operational Limitations

- **No distributed consensus**: a single node vibrating triggers a global alert. Door slam in one room → all admins notified. Mitigation: require N of M nodes to agree before sending.
- **Rate limiting**: 10+ nodes sending simultaneously risk hitting Telegram's 30 msg/s global limit. Mitigation: aggregate into one message (`Node1:OK|Node2:ALERT|Node3:OK`).

7 Conclusion

This PoC validates the core feasibility of an ESP32-based seismic monitoring system at minimal cost. The dual-thread architecture successfully decouples latency-sensitive sensor polling from blocking network I/O. The threshold-based classifier provides acceptable noise discrimination for a data-center deployment scenario. The primary gap remains mechanical: a single-axis, frequency-only sensor cannot produce a calibrated Richter magnitude. This would require a tri-axis MEMS accelerometer (e.g., MPU-6050) as a hardware upgrade path.